

ENCLOSURE TO
FLEET MONTHLY
ROR – APRIL 2017

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FOR APRIL 2017

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

PART 1

1. Who does these Rules apply to? (R1a)(1)

2. In construing and complying with these rules, due regard shall be had to what? (R. 2b) (3)

3. Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel, or the owner, master or crew thereof from what consequence? (R2a)(3)

4. When is a vessel deemed to be a "vessel engaged in fishing"? (R. 3d) (1)

5. In accordance with the Rules “every vessel shall at all times maintain a proper lookout by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate in the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision”. Give 6 practical examples of maintaining a proper lookout (R.5)(3).

6. In accordance with the Rule regarding safe speed, what are the 2 key reasons for a vessel to proceed at a safe speed? (R.6)(1)

7. To meet the requirements for safe speed, what factors should all vessels (without operational radar) take into account? (R.6)(3)

8. How should a vessel determine if risk of collision exists in any condition of visibility? What shall you do if in doubt? (R.7a)(1)(1)

9. In determining if risk of collision exists, give 2 considerations regarding compass bearing change, type of vessel or the proximity of the vessel, which shall be taken into account according to the Rules? (R.7d (i)&(ii))(2)

10. According to the Rules, any alteration of course and/or speed to avoid collision shall be what? (R.8b)(2)

11. How should a vessel proceed along the course of a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9a)(1)

12. Which vessels shall avoid impeding the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9 b&c)(3)

13. When is a vessel deemed to be an overtaking? (R.13b)(1)

14. When one of two vessels is required to keep out of the way, what shall the other vessel do? (R.17 a(i))(1)

15. When does the Rule concerning restricted visibility apply? (R.19a)(1)

16. What lights do you expect a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre (not conducting mine clearance operations) making way through the water to exhibit? (R.27b (i)&(iii))(2)

Part 2

You are the Officer of the Watch¹ in HMS KENT (length 133m), sailing from Portsmouth in the forenoon for an overnight transit to Dover. The QHM Pilot is embarked for departure and the ship is at immediate notice for sea. The weather is fine, good visibility but fog patches is forecast in the Dover TSS during the First Watch.

17. When will the ship be deemed to be underway? (R.3i)(1)

18. As you get underway, you sight a group of sailing vessels at GREEN 20 in vicinity of Spit Sand Fort. You are considered to be in a Narrow channel. What does the Rule require of them regarding your safe passage? (R9.b)(1)

19. One yellow mast sailing vessel starts crossing the channel and is now on a steady bearing with CPA in 10 minutes. You are in doubt of her intentions, what sound signals can you use to indicate such doubt? (R.34d)(1)

20. The Siren fails to work and the DMEO is having to explain to the CO why that is the case. It is expected to be fixed in 15 minutes. What other else can be used to signal your misunderstanding? (R.34d)(1)

21. The sailing vessel gets stranded in the middle of the channel and risk of collision is imminent. In accordance with the IRPCS, who is the give way vessel? (R.2b, R.8f(iii), R.18a)(1)

22. The sailing vessel is towed away by the Police launch and you continue with the Transit. At Green 50, range 4nm you sight a merchant vessel (MV) from Southampton. CPA is 1c on the ship's head. Who is the give way vessel? (R.15)(1)

23. If the circumstances of the case admit, what must you avoid? (R15)(1)

24. The CO decides to reduce speed to disembark the Pilot at OSB, at the same time increasing the CPA of the MV to 5c. The POAWW asks you what light the pilot vessel would display at night when underway so he can brief the force protection team. (R.29(i)(ii))(3)

25. What would she display during the day? (1)

26. As you turn to the Southeast, you hear on channel 12 to Southampton VTS that a Vessel Constrained by Draught (CBD) is passing Nab Tower and following the Deep Water Route. How will you define a CBD and what should she display during the day, and at night in addition to the lights of a power driven vessel? (R.3h & R.28)(3)

27. You sight the CBD displaying the appropriate shape(s) at Green 30 with a CPA of 2c to port in 15 minutes. If the circumstances of the case admit, what are you required to do in accordance with the Rules? (R.18d(i))(1)

28. The NO advises the CO to cut across New Grounds to stay clear of the CBD and proceed directly to your box in vicinity of the entrance to the Dover TSS. What does the Rule say about vessels navigating in areas near the vicinity of the termination of the traffic separation scheme? (R.10f)(1)

29. SSD falls out and you leave the Bridge for your lunch. You return after sunset for you "First" watch. As forecasted, visibility deteriorates and at a maximum of 3c. You report to the CO, close up fog lookouts and decide to sound signals. What will it be (you are making way) and at what intervals? (R.35a)(2).

30. Your port lookout reports a sound signal at intervals less than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts. What type of vessel could it be? (R.35a)((3)

31. The lookout reports the sound signal coming from forward of the beam. You do not have the contact on radar. What will your actions be? (R.19e)(2)

Not long after that vessel passes clear, you relief arrives for your handover.

Part 2 _____ /21
TOTAL _____ /50

PART 1

1. Who does these Rules apply to? (R1a)(1)

These Rules shall apply to all vessels upon the high seas and in all waters connected therewith, navigable by sea going vessels. (½ mark each)

2. In construing and complying with these rules, due regard shall be had to what? (R. 2b) (3)

In construing and complying with these Rules due regard shall be had to all dangers of navigation and collision and to any special circumstances, including the limitations of the vessels involved, which may make a departure from these rules necessary to avoid immediate danger. (1 mark each)

3. Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel, or the owner, master or crew thereof from what consequence? (R2a)(3)

Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel, or the owner, master or crew thereof from the consequence of any neglect to comply with these Rules or of the neglect of any precaution which may be required by the ordinary practice of seamen, or by the special circumstances of the case. (1 mark each)

4. When is a vessel deemed to be a “vessel engaged in fishing”? (R. 3d) (1)

The term vessel engaged in fishing means any vessel fishing with nets, lines, trawls or other fishing apparatus which restrict manoeuvrability, but does not include a vessel fishing with trolling lines or other fishing apparatus which do not restrict manoeuvrability.

5. In accordance with the Rules “every vessel shall at all times maintain a proper lookout by sight and hearing as well as by all available means appropriate in the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision”. Give 6 practical examples of maintaining a proper lookout (R.5)(3).

Any 6 from the list below not limited to the list: (½ mark each)

Visual lookout by sight
Visual lookout with binoculars
Use of TV cameras on weapon systems
Use of IR
Listening on VHF
Engine sounds
Sound signals from other vessels
Reports from helicopter
Link tracks
Signal reports
Intelligence report

6. In accordance with the Rule regarding safe speed, what are the 2 key reasons for a vessel to proceed at a safe speed? (R.6)(1)

Every vessel shall at all times proceed at a safe speed so that she can take proper and effective action to avoid collision and be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions. (½ mark each)

7. To meet the requirements for safe speed, what factors should all vessels (without operational radar) take into account? (R.6)(3)

In determining a safe speed the following factors shall be amongst those taken into account: (½ mark each)

- a. **The state of visibility**
- b. **The traffic density including concentration of fishing vessels or any other vessels**
- c. **The manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to the stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions**
- d. **At night the presence of background light such as from shore lights or from backscatter of her own lights**
- e. **The state of wind, sea and current and proximity of navigational hazards**
- f. **The draught in relation to the available depth of water**

8. How should a vessel determine if risk of collision exists in any condition of visibility? What shall you do if in doubt? (R.7a)(1)(1)

Every vessel shall use all available means appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions to determine if risk of collision exists. If there is any doubt, such risk shall be deemed to exist.(1 mark each)

9. In determining if risk of collision exists, give 2 considerations regarding compass bearing change, type of vessel or the proximity of the vessel, which shall be taken into account according to the Rules? (R.7d (i)&(ii))(2)

In determining if risk of collision exists the following considerations shall be among those taken into account: (1 mark each paragraph)

- a. **Such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change**
- b. **Such risk may sometimes still exist even when an appreciable bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or a tow or when approaching a vessel at close range.**

10. According to the Rules, any alteration of course and/or speed to avoid collision shall be what? (R.8b)(2)

Any alteration of course and/or speed to avoid collision shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, be large enough to be readily apparent to another vessel observing visually or by radar; a succession of small alterations of course and/or speed should be avoided.(1 mark each)

11. How should a vessel proceed along the course of a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9a)(1)

A vessel proceeding along the course of a narrow channel or fairway shall keep as near to the outer limit of the channel or fairway which lies on her starboard side as is safe and practicable.

12. Which vessels shall avoid impeding the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9 b&c)(3)

A vessel less than 20m in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway. (1 mark each)

A vessel engaged in fishing shall not impede the passage of any other vessel navigating within a narrow channel or fairway. (1 mark)

13. When is a vessel deemed to be an overtaking? (R.13b)(1)

A vessel shall be deemed to be overtaking when coming up with another vessel from a direction more than 22.5° abaft the beam, that is, in such a position with reference to the vessel she is overtaking, that at night she would be able to see only the sternlight of that vessel but neither of her sidelights.

14. When one of two vessels is required to keep out of the way, what shall the other vessel do? (R.17 a(i))(1)

When one of two vessels is required to keep out of the way of another vessel, the other shall keep her course and speed.

15. When does the Rule concerning restricted visibility apply? (R.19a)(1)

This Rule applies to a vessel not in sight of one another when navigating in or near an area of restricted visibility.

16. What lights do you expect a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre (not conducting mine clearance operations) making way through the water to exhibit? (R.27b (i)&(iii))(2)

A vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, except a vessel engaged in mine clearance operations, shall exhibit:

Three all-round lights in a vertical line where they can best be seen. The highest and lowest shall be red and the middle shall be white (1/2 mark)

When making way through the water, a masthead light or lights, sidelights and a sternlight, in addition to the lights prescribed in sub paragraph (i) (1/2 mark each)

PART 2

You are the Officer of the Watch¹ in HMS KENT (length 133m), sailing from Portsmouth in the forenoon for an overnight transit to Dover. The QHM Pilot is embarked for departure and the ship is at immediate notice for sea. The weather is fine, good visibility but fog patches is forecast in the Dover TSS during the First Watch.

17. When will the ship be deemed to be underway? (R.3i)(1)

The word underway means that a vessel is not at anchor, or made fast to the shore, or aground.

18. As you get underway, you sight a group of sailing vessels at GREEN 20 in vicinity of Spit Sand Fort. You are considered to be in a Narrow channel. What does the Rule require of them regarding your safe passage? (R9.b)(1)

A vessel less than 20m in length or a sailing vessel shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway.

19. One yellow mast sailing vessel starts crossing the channel and is now on a steady bearing with CPA in 10 minutes. You are in doubt of her intentions, what sound signals can you use to indicate such doubt? (R.34d)(1)

When vessels in sight of one another are approaching each other and from any cause either vessel fails to understand the intentions or actions of the other, or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blasts on her whistle. Such signal may be supplemented by light signal of at least five short rapid flashes.

20. The Siren fails to work and the DMEO is having to explain to the CO why that is the case. It is expected to be fixed in 15 minutes. What other else can be used to signal your misunderstanding? (R.34d)(1)

See answer above.

21. The sailing vessel gets stranded in the middle of the channel and risk of collision is imminent. In accordance with the IRPCS, who is the give way vessel? (R.2b, R.18a)(1)

Except where Rule 9, 10 and 13 require:

A power driven vessel underway shall keep out of the way of: a sailing vessel

22. The sailing vessel is towed away by the Police launch and you continue with the Transit. At Green 50, range 4nm you sight a merchant vessel (MV) from Southampton. CPA is 1c on the ship's head. Who is the give way vessel? (R.15)(1)

When two power driven vessels are crossing so as to involve risk of collision, the vessel which has the other on her own starboard side shall keep out of the way and shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid crossing ahead of the other vessel.

23. If the circumstances of the case admit, what must you avoid? (R15)(1)

See above answer

24. The CO decides to reduce speed to disembark the Pilot at OSB, at the same time increasing the CPA of the MV to 5c. The POAWW asks you what light the pilot vessel would display at night when underway so he can brief the force protection team. (R.29(i)(ii))(3)

A vessel engaged on pilotage duties shall exhibit: (1 mark each)

- a. **At or near the masthead, two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being white and the lower red;**
- b. **When underway, in addition, sidelights and a sternlight;**

25. What would she display during the day? (1)

Flag Hotel

26. As you turn to the Southeast, you hear on channel 12 to Southampton VTS that a Vessel Constrained by Draught (CBD) is passing Nab Tower and following the Deep Water Route. How will you define a CBD and what should she display during the day, and at night in addition to the lights of a power driven vessel? (R.3h & R.28)(3)

3h. The term vessel constrained by her draught means a power-driven vessel which, because of her draught in relation to the available depth and with of navigable water, is severely restricted in her ability to deviate from the course she is following. (1 mark)

R.28. A vessel constrained by her draught may, in addition to the lights prescribed for power-driven vessels in Rule 23, exhibit where they can best be seen three all-round red lights in a vertical line, or a cylinder. (1 mark each)

27. You sight the CBD displaying the appropriate shape(s) at Green 30 with a CPA of 2c to port in 15 minutes. If the circumstances of the case admit, what are you required to do in accordance with the Rules? (R.18d(i))(1)

Any vessel other than a vessel not under command or a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre shall, if the circumstances of the case admit, avoid impeding the safe passage of a vessel constrained by her draught, exhibiting the signals in Rule 28.

28. The NO advises the CO to cut across New Grounds to stay clear of the CBD and proceed directly to your box in vicinity of the entrance to the Dover TSS. What does the Rule say about vessels navigating in areas near the vicinity of the termination of the traffic separation scheme? (R.10f)(1)

A vessel navigating in areas near the termination of traffic separation schemes shall do so with particular caution.

29. SSD falls out and you leave the Bridge for your lunch. You return after sunset for you "First" watch. As forecasted, visibility deteriorates and at a maximum of 3c. You report to the CO, close up fog lookouts and decide to sound signals. What will it be (you are making way) and at what intervals? (R.35a)(2).

A power driven vessel making way through the water shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes one prolonged blast. (1 mark each)

30. Your port lookout reports a sound signal at intervals less than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts. What type of vessel could it be? (R.35a)((3)

A vessel not under command, a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, a vessel constrained by her draught, a sailing vessel, a vessel engaged in fishing, and a vessel engaged in towing another vessel shall, instead of the signals prescribed in paragraphs (a) or (b) of this Rule, sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts. (1/2 mark each)

31. The lookout reports the sound signal coming from forward of the beam. You do not have the contact on radar. What will your actions be? (R.19e)(2)

Except where it has been determined that a risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close-quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam, shall reduce her speed to the minimum at which she can be kept on her course. She shall if necessary take all her way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until danger of collision is over. (1 mark each)

Not long after that vessel passes clear, you relief arrives for your handover.

Part 2 _____ /21

TOTAL _____ /50